

ENGLISH

1. Passage anchor

> “One person who has had a really important influence on my life is my secondary school
English teacher, Mrs. Chan.”

Passage meaning

English = the English language considered as a school subject

英文；英語（科目）

In:

> **English teacher**

English identifies what Mrs. Chan taught:

= **英文老師 / 英語教師**

Practice

1. My **English teacher** encouraged me to speak more confidently.
我的**英文老師**鼓勵我更有自信地說話。
2. **English** was one of my favourite subjects at school.
英文是我在學校最喜歡的科目之一。

Core meanings of ENGLISH

2. English — the English language

= the language spoken natively in countries such as the UK, the US, Australia, and others, and
widely used internationally

英語；英文

Examples

1. She speaks fluent **English**.
她能說流利的**英語**。
2. I use **English** at work every day.
我每天工作時都使用**英文**。

This is the central meaning.

3. speak English

= communicate orally using the English language

說英語；講英文

Examples

1. Do you **speak English**?

你會**說英文**嗎？

2. She became more confident about **speaking English** in public.

她在公開場合**說英文**時變得更有自信。

4. written English

= English as used in writing

書面英語；英文寫作

Examples

1. Formal **written English** differs from casual conversation.

正式**書面英語**和日常對話有所不同。

2. His **written English** has improved significantly.

他的**英文寫作能力**有明顯進步。

5. spoken English

= English as used in speech

口語英語；英語口語

Examples

1. The course focuses on **spoken English**.

這門課著重於**英語口語**。

2. Natural **spoken English** often contains contractions.

自然的**英語口語**常會使用縮約形式。

School subject

6. English — academic subject

= the school or university subject involving the English language, and sometimes literature and writing

****英文科；英語科；英國語文****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. I did well in ****English**** at school.
我在學校的****英文科****表現很好。
2. We have ****English**** three times a week.
我們每星期上三堂****英文課****。

7. English class

= lesson or course in the English language or English-related studies

****英文課；英語課****

Examples

1. We gave presentations in ****English class****.
我們在****英文課****上做簡報。
2. She rarely spoke during ****English class****.
她上****英文課****時很少發言。

8. English teacher

= teacher who teaches the English language or English as a school subject

****英文老師；英語教師****

Examples

1. My ****English teacher**** gave me useful feedback.

我的**英文老師**給了我很有用的回饋。

2. She hopes to become an **English teacher**.
她希望成為一名**英語教師**。

Important ambiguity

an English teacher can theoretically mean:

1. **a teacher of English**
→ **英文老師**
2. **a teacher who is English**
→ **英格蘭籍的老師**

Normally, context resolves this.

In the passage, it clearly means:

teacher of the English language.

English-language content

9. English — expressed or written in English

Used attributively before nouns:

- * English book
- * English newspaper
- * English website
- * English sentence

= **英文的；以英語寫成的**

Examples

1. I bought an **English dictionary**.
我買了一本**英文字典**。
2. She reads **English newspapers** online.
她在網路上閱讀**英文報紙**。

Context is important because **English + noun** can sometimes instead mean “from England.”

National / cultural adjective

10. English — relating to England

= originating in, belonging to, or characteristic of **England**

英格蘭的；英格蘭人的

Examples

1. They visited several **English villages**.

他們參觀了幾個**英格蘭村莊**。

2. The novel describes life in the **English countryside**.

這本小說描寫**英格蘭鄉村**生活。

Important

English does NOT mean exactly the same as **British**.

People

11. English — the people of England collectively

> **the English**

= English people considered collectively

英格蘭人

Examples

1. The custom became popular among **the English**.

這項習俗在**英格蘭人**之間流行起來。

2. The book discusses the history of **the English**.

這本書討論**英格蘭人的歷史**。

Grammar

Normally:

> **the English**

not:

> *an English* ✗

For one person, say:

* an English person

* an Englishman

* an Englishwoman

depending on context.

12. an English person

= a person from England

英格蘭人

Examples

1. She is **English**.

她是**英格蘭人**。

2. He is **an English person living abroad**.

他是一位住在海外的**英格蘭人**。

Variety of the language

13. British English

= forms and usage of English associated especially with the United Kingdom, particularly Britain

英式英語

Examples

1. **British English** usually uses *colour* with a **u**.

英式英語通常把 *colour* 拼成帶 **u** 的形式。

2. The textbook mainly teaches **British English**.

這本課本主要教授**英式英語**。

14. American English

= forms and usage of English associated with the United States

****美式英語****

Examples

1. *Apartment* is especially common in ****American English****.
Apartment 在****美式英語****中特別常見。
2. She is familiar with both British and ****American English****.
她對英式和****美式英語****都很熟悉。

15. Australian / Canadian / Indian / Singaporean English, etc.

****English**** can refer to established geographical varieties of the language.

Examples:

- * Australian English → ****澳洲英語****
- * Canadian English → ****加拿大英語****
- * Indian English → ****印度英語****
- * Singaporean English → ****新加坡英語****

Examples

1. Different varieties of ****English**** have different vocabulary.
不同種類的****英語****會使用不同詞彙。
2. The pronunciation is common in Australian ****English****.
這個發音在澳洲****英語****中很常見。

Language proficiency

16. someone's English

= someone's ability or usage of the English language

****某人的英文能力 / 英語程度****

Examples

1. Her ****English**** has improved a lot.

她的**英文程度**進步很多。

2. His **English** is excellent.
他的**英語能力**很好。

Here, **English** refers metonymically to proficiency in the language.

17. improve your English

= improve your ability to understand or use English
提升英文能力

Examples

1. Reading regularly can help you **improve your English**.
規律閱讀可以幫助你**提升英文能力**。
2. She wanted to **improve her English** before studying abroad.
她想在出國留學前**提升自己的英文程度**。

Type / level of language

18. formal English

= English appropriate for formal situations
正式英語；正式英文

Examples

1. Academic writing usually requires more **formal English**.
學術寫作通常需要較**正式的英文**。
2. This phrase sounds too casual for **formal English**.
這個片語對**正式英語**來說太口語化了。

19. informal / conversational English

= English used casually in everyday conversation
非正式英語；日常口語英文

Examples

1. The expression is common in **informal English**.
這個表達在**非正式英語**中很常見。
2. The book teaches natural **conversational English**.
這本書教授自然的**英語會話**。

20. Standard English

= forms of English conventionally accepted in formal education, publishing, and other institutional contexts

標準英語

Examples

1. Students are expected to use **Standard English** in formal essays.
學生寫正式作文時通常被要求使用**標準英語**。
2. Many regional forms differ from **Standard English** without necessarily being random or incorrect.
許多地區語言形式與**標準英語**不同，但不代表它們毫無規律或必然錯誤。

21. plain English

= clear, simple language that avoids unnecessary complexity or specialist terminology

淺白英文；簡明易懂的英語

Examples

1. Please explain the rule in **plain English**.
請用**簡單易懂的英文**解釋這條規則。
2. The guide translates technical language into **plain English**.
這份指南把技術性語言改寫成**淺白英文**。

This is a high-value fixed expression.

“In English”

22. in English

= using the English language

用英文；以英語

Examples

1. Please answer **in English**.

請**用英文**回答。

2. How do you say this **in English**?

這個**用英文**怎麼說？

Historical / linguistic labels

23. Old English

= earliest historical stage of the English language, used in England roughly before the Norman Conquest and its aftermath

古英語

Examples

1. Modern English developed partly from **Old English**.

現代英語部分源自**古英語**。

2. **Old English** looks very different from modern English.

古英語和現代英語看起來非常不同。

24. Middle English

= historical stage between Old English and Early Modern English

中古英語

Examples

1. Chaucer wrote in **Middle English**.

喬叟使用**中古英語**寫作。

2. English changed considerably during the **Middle English** period.

英語在**中古英語時期**發生了很大變化。

25. Modern English

= the later historical stage of English that includes present-day English

****現代英語****

Examples

1. The word survives in ****Modern English****.
這個詞仍存在於****現代英語****中。
2. ****Modern English**** contains vocabulary from many historical sources.
****現代英語****包含來自多種歷史來源的詞彙。

The unusual noun “English” in billiards

26. English — spin put on a ball

In billiards and pool, especially American usage:

= spin imparted to the cue ball by striking it away from the centre

****旋轉；側旋****

Examples

1. He put some ****English**** on the cue ball.
他讓母球帶了一些****旋轉****。
2. Using ****English**** changes the path of the ball after contact.
使用****側旋****會改變球碰撞後的路線。

This is an established but specialist sense and is ****not learner priority**** unless billiards is relevant.

Capitalization

27. English normally takes a capital E

Correct:

* ****English****

* ****English teacher****

* **English language**

Not normally:

* *english* ✗

because names of languages and nationalities are capitalized in English.

Word-family / related nationality terms

28. England

= the country that forms part of the United Kingdom and is the source of the adjective **English**
英格蘭

Example

London is the capital of **England** and of the United Kingdom.
倫敦是**英格蘭**以及英國的首都。

29. Englishman

= male person from England
英格蘭男性；英格蘭人

Example

He was an **Englishman** living in France.
他是一位住在法國的**英格蘭人**。

30. Englishwoman

= female person from England
英格蘭女性；英格蘭人

Example

She was the first **Englishwoman** on the team.
她是團隊中的第一位**英格蘭女性**。

In many contexts, **English person** is more neutral and convenient.

Key contrasts

31. English vs England

England

= place / country

英格蘭

English

= language, nationality, or adjective relating to England

英語；英格蘭的 / 人

Compare:

> She lives in **England**.

> 她住在英格蘭。

> She speaks **English**.

> 她說英語。

> She is **English**.

> 她是英格蘭人。

32. English vs British

This distinction is essential.

English

= specifically relating to **England**

British

= relating to the **United Kingdom / Great Britain**, depending on context

英國的；英國人

Someone from England can normally be both:

* English

* British

But a Scottish person is:

* British ✓

* English ✗

Likewise, **English** and **British** should not be treated as interchangeable nationality terms.

33. English vs UK

English is not the adjective for the entire United Kingdom.

The UK contains:

* England

* Scotland

* Wales

* Northern Ireland

So:

> English culture

> **英格蘭文化**

is not necessarily identical to:

> British culture

> **英國文化**

34. English vs England's

English is the normal adjective:

> English history

> 英格蘭歷史

England's is possessive:

> England's population

> 英格蘭的人口

They overlap in some contexts but are grammatically different.

35. English vs English language

Usually **English** alone is sufficient:

> I speak **English**.

the English language is fuller and often more formal:

> the history of **the English language**

= **英語這門語言的歷史**

36. English vs English literature

English

as a school subject may mean mainly language study in one educational context.

English literature

specifically means:

= study or body of literature written in English or associated with English literary study

英語文學 ; 英國文學 depending on context

The two should not automatically be treated as identical.

Important ambiguity: English + noun

37. English + noun can have different interpretations

Language meaning

> an **English lesson**

> **英文課**

> an **English word**

> **英文單字**

England meaning

> an **English village**

> **英格蘭村莊**

> an **English tradition**

> **英格蘭傳統**

Therefore, the noun after **English** and the surrounding context determine the interpretation.

Meaning map

The central historical relationship is:

England

→ its people and things associated with it

→ **English**

One major branch then became the name of the language:

Language

English

→ **英語 / 英文**

From that develop:

School subject

English

→ **英文科**

Ability

her English

→ **她的英文能力**

Language variety

British English

→ **英式英語**

Register

formal English

→ **正式英語**

Separately, the geographical/national branch remains:

Relating to England

English village

→ **英格蘭的村莊**

People

the English

→ **英格蘭人**

And there is one specialist unrelated-looking extension:

Billiards

put English on the ball

→ **使球產生旋轉**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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English — language	英語這門語言；英文
speak English	使用英語進行口語溝通；說英文
spoken English	英語在口頭交談中的形式；英語口語
written English	以文字形式使用的英語；書面英文
English — school subject	在學校學習英語語言、寫作等內容的英文科 / 英語科
English class	教授或學習英語的課堂；英文課
English teacher — subject sense	教授英語 / 英文科的老師
English + text/media noun	以英語寫成、表達或製作的；英文的
English — relating to England	與英格蘭、英格蘭文化或英格蘭人有關的
English — nationality	來自英格蘭的；英格蘭人的
the English	作為整體來看的英格蘭人
someone's English	某人理解或使用英語的能力 / 英文程度
improve your English	提升使用、理解、閱讀或書寫英語的能力
British English	與英國、尤其英式用法相關的英語變體；英式英語
American English	與美國使用方式相關的英語變體；美式英語
formal English	適合正式場合、正式寫作的英語
informal/conversational English	日常、非正式交談使用的英語
Standard English	正式教育、出版等場合普遍採用的標準化英語形式
plain English	避免不必要複雜詞語、清楚易懂的英語
in English	使用英語來表達；用英文
Old English	英語最早的重要歷史階段；古英語

Middle English	古英語與早期現代英語之間的歷史階段；中古英語	
Modern English	包含現代英語在內的較後期英語發展階段	
English — billiards	撞球中使母球產生的旋轉 / 側旋	
England	英格蘭；English 所對應的國家名稱	

Passage recap

> “...my secondary school **English teacher**, Mrs. Chan.”

Here:

English = **the English language as a subject being taught**

Therefore:

> **English teacher**

= **a teacher who teaches English**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **英文老師**

* **英語教師**

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

English in **“English teacher”**

= **the English language / English as a school subject**

英文；英語；英文科

It does **not** primarily mean:

> **English = from England**

in this sentence.

So the intended reading is:

> an **English teacher**

> = **英文老師**

rather than:

> a teacher who happens to be **English**

> = **一位英格蘭籍老師**

Context makes the intended meaning clear.